

AI Builder Challenge

First Time at the Castle

Electric Castle is the kind of festival people fall in love with.

But before that happens, there's usually a small panic episode.

How do I get to Bonțida?

Where do I sleep if I'm not a tent person?

What happens if it rains?

How much money do I actually need?

What should I see if I don't know half the line-up?

And how do I convince the group chat that this is, in fact, a good idea?

This is where you come in.

We're challenging AI builders to create a smart first-timer tool that makes Electric Castle feel easier to understand, easier to plan and a lot easier to say yes to.

It can work as a chatbot.

It can work as a webpage with one simple search box.

It can work as a guided planner that asks a few basic questions and builds your EC plan.

It can work as all of the above.

The important thing is that people can either ask anything they care about or let the tool guide them when they don't know where to start.

Not another cold chatbot that answers like it works in a bank.

More like that one friend who's already been to EC, knows where the shuttle is, knows what shoes to wear, knows which stage fits your mood and somehow has a plan even when the weather app has trust issues.

What we want you to build

A prototype for an AI-powered first-timer assistant that helps someone who has never been to Electric Castle plan their first time at the festival.

The experience can work in three ways:

Free search

A simple webpage where the user types any topic, question or worry into one box.

Examples:

“transport from Bucharest”

“where should I sleep if I don’t want camping?”

“what should I pack if it rains?”

“party music and mainstream artists”

“2-day plan with friends”

“how much money do I need?”

“first time at EC, please make this easy”

Chat mode

A conversational assistant where the user can ask follow-up questions, clarify things and get answers that feel natural, not robotic.

Guided planner

A flow that asks the user 4-5 basic questions and then builds a personalized EC plan.

For example:

Where are you coming from?

How many people are you coming with?

How many days do you want to stay?

What kind of accommodation are you comfortable with?

What kind of music or festival mood are you into?

What’s the one thing that stresses you most: transport, budget, weather, camping, not knowing the line-up, convincing the group?

Based on those answers, the tool should generate a simple plan for that person or group.

The user should also be able to say something more personal, like:

“Sunt din București, n-am mai fost la EC, am 29 de ani, nu vreau cort, vin cu încă 3 prieteni, putem sta 2 zile, ne place muzica mai party/mainstream și mă stresează puțin transportul și ploaia.”

And the tool should basically answer:

“Ok. Here’s your easiest way to do EC.”

Then build a useful plan around that person.

What the tool should help with

1. Getting there without losing the will to live

The tool should explain the best transport options in a simple way: how to get to Cluj, how to get from Cluj to Bonțida, what options exist, what needs to be checked closer to the festival and what's the least stressful version for that specific user.

2. Sleeping somewhere that matches the user's personality

Camping, glamping, accommodation in Cluj, accommodation near Bonțida, maybe the "I need a real bed and a door that locks" option.

The tool should explain the pros, cons and trade-offs for each, especially for people who love the festival idea but don't see themselves becoming tent citizens just yet.

3. Translating the line-up into actual taste

Not just "here is the line-up".

More like:

"Based on what you like, these are the stages, artists and moments you should probably not miss."

The tool should help users discover EC through moods and preferences: party, mainstream, electronic, live, rock, trap, chill, discovery, singalong, "I want to dance but also pretend I'm cultured" and so on.

4. Estimating the full damage

People don't only think about the ticket. They think about the whole thing.

The tool should offer a simple budget estimate: pass or day ticket, transport, accommodation, food, drinks and a little chaos fund, because nobody goes to a festival and spends exactly what they planned.

5. Making weather less dramatic

Rain and mud are part of the EC mythology, but the tool shouldn't just say "haha, embrace it".

It should help people come prepared: shoes, clothes, packing tips, backup plans and small survival wisdom that can turn bad weather from a dealbreaker into a story.

6. Answering the practical stuff instantly

Wristbands, top-up, access, camping, shuttle, parking, lockers, showers, food, cashless, kids, day tickets, allowed items, forbidden items, lost friends, lost dignity.

The tool should answer from an approved EC knowledge base and know when to say “check this closer to the festival”.

7. Turning any search into a useful next step

If someone searches “rain”, they shouldn’t get a generic article about clouds being moody.

They should get useful EC answers: what to pack, what shoes to wear, how mud affects moving around, what to avoid, what to tell the friend who says “nu mai merg dacă plouă”.

If someone searches “budget”, they should get a simple cost breakdown.

If someone searches “mainstream”, they should get music recommendations and stage suggestions.

The box can be simple. The answer should be smart.

8. Building a plan from a few basic answers

The tool should also be able to guide users who don’t know where to start.

After asking a few simple questions, it should generate a personalized first-time EC plan that covers:

- How to get there
- Where to stay
- What ticket type makes sense
- What stages or artists to check out
- What to pack
- What budget to expect
- What to tell the group
- What to check again closer to the festival

Basically, less “here are 27 links, good luck” and more “this is your version of EC”.

9. Helping the group chat decide

This is a big one.

The tool should generate a simple shareable plan for friends. Something people can drop in WhatsApp without needing to write a thesis.

Example:

“Guys, this is our EC plan: we leave Friday, stay in Cluj, take the shuttle to Bonțida, budget is around X, we focus on these stages/artists, we pack rain gear and we do not emotionally collapse if we see mud.”

The idea is to make the tool useful not just for one curious person, but for the whole group trying to decide.

10. Giving EC useful insights

The tool should collect anonymized insights about what people are asking, what scares them, what blocks them and what makes them more likely to come.

No creepy data stuff. Just useful patterns.

What we can give you

We can provide a curated knowledge base with:

Public “Everything You Need To Know” content

Old FAQs

Access, camping, bus, parking, lockers and cashless rules

Stage descriptions and music directions

Public line-up information

Artist tags created by us, like energetic, electronic, live, rock, trap, chill, discovery, singalong

General transport information

General accommodation, camping and glamping options

8 to 10 fictional personas inspired by research

Anonymized or generated frequent questions

Electric Castle tone of voice guidelines

What we expect from your team

By the end, we’d like to see:

A working demo

A first-timer user flow

A simple web or mobile interface. This can be chatbot-based, search-box-based, guided-planner-based or a mix of them.

A basic technical architecture

A list of data needed for real implementation

A measurement plan

Good metrics could include: questions answered, time saved for support, click-through to tickets, purchase intent, completed plans, saved plans, shares to friends, repeated searches and recurring barriers discovered.

How we'll judge it

We'll look at how well the idea works in the real world.

Does it make EC easier for first-timers?

Does it reduce actual anxiety, not imaginary problems?

Can people use it naturally, whether they type a keyword, ask a full question or choose to be guided?

Does it ask the right questions before building a plan?

Does it sound like EC, or like a tax office chatbot with a festival hat?

Can it work without sensitive data?

Could we realistically use part of it in the next 1-2 months?

Does it move people closer to buying a ticket?

Could it reduce repetitive support questions?

Is it shareable enough to help friend groups make a decision together?

What you can win

The winning team gets the chance to take the idea further with Electric Castle.

Possible prizes include:

A chance to pilot the solution on EC website, app or social before the festival, with public credit

Behind-the-scenes access with the EC team during build-up

EC merch pack / limited edition goodies

A private demo or testing session at the EC office

Feature on EC channels, LinkedIn or PR

Potential internship or paid implementation contract

In one sentence

Build the tool that turns any first-timer panic, search or “where do I even start?” moment into “ok, we’re doing this”.